

**EPIC MODULE:
EMOTIVES**

v2.0

EMOTIVES-1

VOCABULARY

Strong	Bright — Dark
Emphasis	Warp — Blur
Diminished	Reveal — Fade
Rise — Fall	Open — Contained
Converge — Drift	Smooth — Turbulent
Swell — Decay	Tight — Loose
Energetic — Calm	Pulse — Flash

DESCRIPTION

Emotives describe the expressive character of a moment. They communicate how something should feel, rather than prescribing specific visual techniques. Because emotives represent perceptual intent, implementations are free to interpret them using typography, motion, lighting, particle systems, or other visual means.

Most emotives exist in paired axes, representing opposite ends of a conceptual dimension such as direction, energy, or atmosphere. These axes are independent and may be combined to describe complex expressive states.

In addition to these axes, EPIC defines three focus modifiers—strong, emphasis, and diminished. These modifiers do not describe motion or atmosphere. Instead, they indicate the relative semantic importance of words, phrases or events within a moment.

EMOTIVES-2

PROMINENCE MODIFIERS

Strong
Emphasis
Diminished

MOVEMENT LAYER

Direction:

Rise — Fall

Collection:

Converge — Drift

DYNAMICS LAYER

Intensity:

Swell — Decay

Energy:

Energetic — Calm

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PERCEPTION LAYER

Atmosphere:

Bright — Dark

Distortion:

Warp — Blur

Visibility:

Reveal — Fade

Expressive Space:

Open — Contained

Micro-motion:

Smooth — Turbulent

Timing:

Tight — Loose
Pulse — Flash

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DEFINITIONS-1

Strong:

Designates an element as the semantic anchor of the moment.

Emphasis:

Increases the perceptual prominence of an element relative to surrounding elements.

Diminished:

Reduces the perceptual prominence of an element relative to surrounding elements.

Rise:

Directional upward progression in motion or intensity.

Fall:

Directional downward progression in motion or intensity.

Converge:

Movement directed toward a shared focal point.

Drift:

Motion without clear directional intent; ambient or wandering.

Swell:

Gradual accumulation of intensity, density, or presence.

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DEFINITIONS-2

Decay:

Gradual reduction or dispersal of intensity, density, or presence.

Energetic:

High activity level with vigorous or frequent motion.

Calm:

Low activity level with restrained or minimal motion.

Bright:

Airy, bright, or elevated atmospheric tone.

Dark:

Heavy, dense, or weighty atmospheric tone.

Warp:

Distortion that alters meaning or form.

Blur:

Distortion that reduces clarity or sharpness.

Reveal:

Transition into visibility or perceptual awareness.

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DEFINITIONS-3

Fade:

Transition out of visibility or perceptual awareness.

Open:

Expressive room becoming more expansive or open.

Contained:

Expressive room becoming more restrictive or contained.

Smooth:

Uniform motion with minimal irregularity or turbulence.

Turbulent:

Irregular or chaotic motion with unpredictable variation.

Tight:

Motion closely aligned with timing cues or rhythmic events.

Loose:

Motion that stretches or relaxes around timing cues.

Pulse:

Periodic or rhythmic repetition over time.

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DEFINITIONS-4

Flash:

A sudden, instantaneous perceptual event.

EMOTIVES-8

ARCS-1

ARCS

DESCRIPTION

Emotive arcs describe the behavior arc over time. Arcs give the evolutionary description for an emotive recipe's lifecycle.

Arc Drop:

peaks early, then
tapers over time

Arc Lift:

peaks at the end, beginning
rises to match peak

Arc:

peak is centrally located

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RECIPES & EXAMPLES

The intent of emotives is to describe emotional expression, not configure performance. In that sense, the following recipes are examples and should NOT be viewed as canonical combinations. For example, a given scene may require “romantic” which could be “smooth, calm, drift, open”. But a specific attribute of that particular scene may be “growth” or expansion in context of what is around it, so one might add “swell”, as well. The key takeaway is that primitives (emotives) capture components of a scene, and when combined, give character and distinction to it.

Sensual

{{smooth, blur, drift,
swell, open}}

Romantic

{{smooth, calm, drift, open}}